

Virtkick has all the essential features wrapped in a beautiful user interface just like an app. Its tidy admin panel runs the server without tech expertise and gives users the plug-and-play feel. Even billing is made easy, as the billing mechanism is built into it and the invoices are generated automatically. Now, let's take a walk-through to know more about it.

Virtkick has a single button for creating new machines. On clicking it, you get the option to choose from different plans, and each plan has its own configuration involving the RAM (ranging from 1GB to 16 GB), SSD (20GB to 100GB) and CPU (one to four in number).

To create a virtual machine, you need an operating system, for which Virtkick provides Ubuntu, Debian, Fedora and many more to choose from. Driver appliances for various Linux distributions will be added in the future. Another feature coming soon is one-click integration with Sandstorm.

Now, to install a server, go to the console where the options will be shown as in Figure 2. If you wish to add a new disk, click the *Storage* tab and then create the new disk (see Figure 3). The scheduler helps in automatically scheduling the server. The *Stats* tab shows you CPU usage, I/O load and the network traffic on the server, and this helps in managing the server. All of this gives the feel of working on a personal computer with just a few installation clicks.

The non-techie's guide to installing Virtkick

For the CentOS operating system, just enter `yum install https://download.virtkick.io/latest.rpm` in a terminal. Then go to `http://yourserver:3000` and skip to the next section, which deals with running the machine. For other environments, clone Virtkick from `@https://github.com/virtkick/virtkick-starter#virtkick-take-cloud-back` and then run it. Here are four easy steps to installing Virtkick in Ubuntu:

```
sudo apt-get install git
git clone https://github.com/virtkick/virtkick-starter.git
cd virtkick-starter
./virtkick-start -dim
```

After the installation, let's take a peek into how this tool works. The Virtkick team has decided to go for a SaaS solution instead of focusing on a self-hosted one. Now what does SaaS mean? You don't have to install Virtkick; you just have to log in to the website, connect with hypervisors via *IP/SSH* and deploy it for your client. The users can focus on their business and the team will look after all the issues—ranging from the upgradation of Virtkick to the proper functioning of SaaS. The inbuilt billing system will help in generating one batch invoice per week, for the client. As far as the billing is concerned, the team has decided to work on a



Figure 1: CreateMachine



Figure 2: Console



Figure 3: CreateDisk

revenue sharing model, where you pay 15 per cent of what you earn through Virtkick.

Virtkick will help you compete with AWS and Digital Ocean, with its simplicity and great user experience. It looks like a mobile app, and works on tablets and phones. You can contact the team at `team@virtkick.com`. Within months of its launch, it has more than 1000 email subscriptions, around 800 GitHub downloads and 15,000 visitors. To add to the good news, Virtkick was one amongst the 10 cloud service providers to get selected for the Techstars Cloud 2015 for which 1200 companies applied. A hassle-free way to the cloud has arrived, and that is via Virtkick. **END**

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